# Further Reading: PDCA Foundations, Guidance and Practical Use

## Reference Sources Informing CIPDA Development

### Purpose

This document provides a curated reading list of publicly available references that informed understanding of PDCA and related improvement approaches.

These sources are provided for further study and comparison only.

Inclusion does not imply endorsement.

Readers are encouraged to review original materials and develop their own interpretations.

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# Foundational Sources

### Shewhart, W.A.

**Economic Control of Quality of Manufactured Product**
Van Nostrand, 1931.

Foundational statistical quality text introducing concepts that later evolved into iterative improvement cycles.

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### Deming, W.E.

**Out of the Crisis**
MIT Press, 1986.

Classic work linking quality, management, systems thinking, and iterative improvement.

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### Deming, W.E.

**The New Economics for Industry, Government, Education**
MIT Press, 1993.

Expands improvement thinking into organisational learning and management systems.

# Historical Development of PDCA / PDSA

### Moen, R. & Norman, C.

**Evolution of the PDCA Cycle**
Presentation to Asian Network for Quality, Tokyo, 2009.

Widely referenced historical review of Shewhart → Deming → PDSA → PDCA development.

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### Langley, G., Moen, R., Nolan, K., Nolan, T., Norman, C., Provost, L.

**The Improvement Guide: A Practical Approach to Enhancing Organizational Performance**
Jossey-Bass, 2009.

Practical handbook applying iterative improvement methods in operational environments.

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# Practical PDCA Guides

### American Society for Quality (ASQ)

Plan–Do–Check–Act (PDCA) Cycle
Available at:
https://asq.org/quality-resources/pdca-cycle

Practical introduction covering:

- when to use PDCA
- implementation steps
- examples
- continuous improvement applications

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### Lean Enterprise Institute

Plan, Do, Check, Act — Resource Guide
Available at:
https://www.lean.org/lexicon-terms/pdca/

Strong practical interpretation emphasising:

- learning cycles

- kaizen
- standard work
- operational improvement

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### W. Edwards Deming Institute

PDSA Cycle
Available at:
https://deming.org/explore/pdsa/

Explains Deming’s preference for “Study” rather than “Check” and positions improvement as structured learning.

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### PECB

The Plan–Do–Check–Act (PDCA) Cycle: A Guide to Continuous Improvement
Available at:
https://pecb.com/en/article/the-plan-do-check-act-pdca-cycle-a-guide-to-continuous-improvement

Useful for:

- management systems
- ISO alignment
- practical implementation guidance

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## PDCA and Quality Management Systems

### ISO 9001

Quality Management Systems — Requirements.

PDCA forms a recurring structural principle across ISO management system implementation.

(Access through authorised standards providers.)

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### Tague, N.

**The Quality Toolbox**
ASQ Quality Press.

Practical reference for applying improvement tools alongside PDCA.

# Lean and Operational Improvement

### Rother, M.

**Toyota Kata**
McGraw-Hill, 2010.

Connects iterative learning, coaching, and improvement routines.

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### Liker, J.

**The Toyota Way**
McGraw-Hill, 2004.

Shows practical operational application of continuous improvement principles.

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# Related Models Worth Exploring

### Kolb, D.

Experiential Learning Cycle

Learning through: Experience → Reflection → Conceptualisation → Experimentation

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### Boyd, J.

OODA Loop
Observe → Orient → Decide → Act

Rapid decision and adaptation cycle.

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### Dignum, V. & Dignum, F.

Emerging work on governable agent behaviour and structured participation.

Useful for considering future AI-assisted operational cycles.

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# Notes for CIPDA Readers

This repository does not claim to replace PDCA.

CIPDA emerged from practical reflection on where classical iterative methods encounter challenges under:

- complexity
- distributed delivery
- AI-supported work
- interpretive variance
- assurance requirements

Readers are encouraged to understand PDCA first.

Then decide whether additional structures are necessary.

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